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Based in Ghent, Belgium



Kenny De Pauw

About

My work is a **unique blend of hands-on technical expertise and leadership** of a 25+ person frontend chapter.

As manager, I drive our platform team's mission: advancing tooling, evolving the design system, and fostering education and knowledge sharing across the organisation and beyond through talks, blog posts and more.

As chapter lead I work with frontend engineers and managers company-wide, involved in architecture, technical direction, process optimisation, hiring, and promotions. If it impacts frontend, I'm engaged, from **strategic decisions to mentoring individual engineers**.

My leadership style is **direct and transparent**. I believe in honest, open communication, empowering people to share their ideas and feedback without fear of judgment. In return I offer clear, actionable feedback, and always stand up for my team.

Key Skills

- Frontend architecture & design systems
- React, Ember.js, JavaScript, TypeScript
- Technical strategy and process optimization

EXPERIENCE

Engineering manager and Frontend chapter lead - Lighthouse

March 2022 - PRESENT

- Lead a 25+ person frontend chapter.
- Steering a high-impact migration from Ember to React, aligning the engineering need and vision with business strategy.
- Ensure frontend engineers can collaborate across teams and across countries by introducing remote friendly ways of working, chapter meetings and regular check ins with the product teams.
- Mentor and develop frontend engineers and managers across our organisation.
- Involved in all technical interviews for frontend engineers, and promotion decisions to scale organisational impact.
- Organise and follow up on AI tooling adoption like Github Copilot across the entire organisation, member of the AI coding steering group.

Tech lead – Lighthouse

January 2018 – March 2022

- Managed a growing frontend team
- Defined and rolled out a growth framework for our software engineers.
- Orchestrated transition to a monorepo, improving developer experience and project velocity.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with Product and Design, ensuring delivery of well-scoped, user-focused solutions.
- Introduced and improved onboarding/documentation for frontend engineers.

Software engineer – Lighthouse

September 2016 – January 2018

- Helped transition to a more modern version of Ember.js.
- Bring new features and products to life in the application.
- Collaborating with the design, product and other engineering teams.
Providing feedback, reviewing code and giving advice to new joiners.

EDUCATION

Ghent University – *Master's degree in Information Technology*

September 2015 – September 2015